the development crisis of the 1980s, in the wake of protracted drought and famine that had engulfed the continent and the crippling effect of Africa's external indebtedness. The New Partnership for Africa's Development (NEPAD) was adopted as a Programme of the AU at the Lusaka Summit (2001).

Despite such laudable efforts, the OAU often faced and at present the AU faces stiff challenges in fostering African Unity due to differences among the member states, civil strife, ethnic conflicts, continued dependence on the former colonizers, inability to enforce its decision, policy of non-interference, making it virtually ineffective in cases of human rights violation and others. The OAU was often viewed as a bureaucratic 'talking shop' with little power and, thus, the AU has a tough job of making itself a more credible regional organization in the eyes of the international community.